

Dianyuan Zou

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Research Interests

Representation Learning; Self-Improvement in Neural Networks; Computer Vision

Education

University of California, Berkeley, Extension

Aug 2026–May 2027

Visiting Student, Berkeley Global Access Program

Berkeley, CA

Huazhong University of Science and Technology

Sep 2023–Jun 2027

B.Eng. Candidate in Electronic Information and Communications

Wuhan, China

Advanced Mathematics and Physics Track

GPA: 4.58/5.00

Publications and Preprints (*: equal contribution)

1. Manni Cui*, Ruiqi Liu*, **Dianyuan Zou***, et al.
GlobalForge: Towards Robust AI-Generated Image Detection
Preprint
2. Manni Cui*, Ziheng Qin*, ZiAn Wang, Ruiqi Liu, **Dianyuan Zou**, et al.
Rethinking the Readout: Unlocking Video Backbones for AI-Generated Video Detection
Neural Information Processing Systems (**NeurIPS**), 2026

Research Experience

Westlake University, ENCODE Lab

Jun 2026–Present

Visiting Research Intern, advised by Prof. Huan Wang

Hangzhou, China

- **Ongoing project:** Investigating whether a vision model learns better representations when it is given the freedom to actively decide where to look next, rather than being fed a fixed set of crops.
- Implemented the training framework (DINO-style self-distillation on a block-causal Vision Transformer with an acquisition head); currently evaluating the learned representations on ImageNet with k-NN, linear, and MLP probes.

AI-Generated Image and Video Detection

Apr 2026–Aug 2026

Research Contributor, HUST

Wuhan, China

- Carried out the experiments on detecting AI-generated images and videos, including fine-tuning and evaluating detection models, in collaboration with project partners and CAS researchers.
- Helped write the manuscripts and create figures. The work led to two papers: *Rethinking the Readout* (NeurIPS 2026) and *GlobalForge* (preprint, co-first author).

RoboMaster Global Robotics Competition – Vision System

Oct 2023–Aug 2025

Algorithm Member, Langya Algorithm Group, HUST

Wuhan, China

- Developed and tuned a real-time auto-aiming computer-vision pipeline in C++ for competition deployment; the team won Second Prizes in the 2025 RoboMaster Series Competitions.
- Collected training data, trained and quantized a YOLO11-s model, and deployed it on an Intel NUC using OpenVINO to accelerate inference.

Honors and Awards

National Scholarship

2024, 2025, 2026

Ministry of Education of China; awarded to about 0.3% of college students each year

Outstanding Student Scholarship

2024, 2025, 2026

Huazhong University of Science and Technology

Second Prizes, RoboMaster Series Competitions

2025

Silver Medal, Chinese Mathematical Olympiad (CMO)

2023

National final of China's high-school mathematics olympiad

Skills

Programming: C, C++, Python.

Machine Learning and Vision: PyTorch, OpenCV.

Systems and Robotics: Linux, ROS2.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese; English (IELTS 7.0).